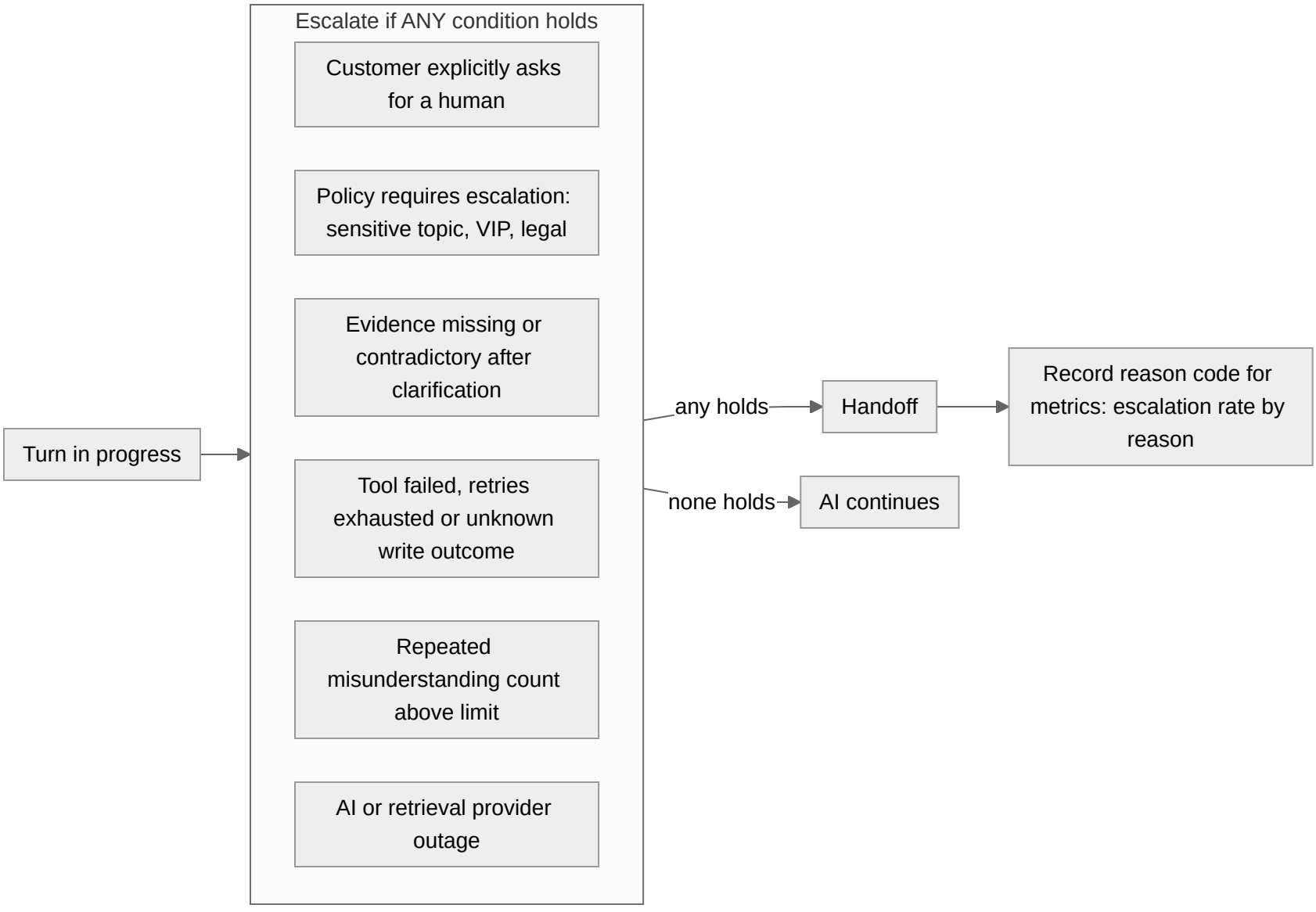
Escalate if ANY condition holds
Customer explicitly asks for a human
Policy requires escalation: sensitive topic, VIP, legal
Evidence missing or contradictory after clarification
Tool failed, retries exhausted or unknown write outcome
Repeated misunderstanding count above limit
AI or retrieval provider outage
Turn in progress
any holds
Handoff
Record reason code for metrics: escalation rate by reason
none holds
AI continues